

APM Project Management Qualification

Learner Study Pack



Leadership

Introduction

This section of the Learner Study Pack will cover the Leadership competence of the APM Project Management Qualification.

This section will enable you to gain an understanding of leadership as the ability to establish vision and direction, to influence and align others towards a common purpose, and to empower and inspire people to achieve success.

Learning objective and outcomes

Learning objective:

12. Understand leadership as ways to empower and inspire others to deliver successful projects.

By the end of this activity, you should be able to:

12a) Understand how leadership impacts on team performance and motivation (using models such as Maslow, Herzberg and McGregor).

12b) Understand why it may be necessary to change leadership styles depending upon the situation.

12c) Understand the importance of a coaching and mentoring style in leadership, and the role of emotional intelligence.

Study time

This section of the Learner Study Pack will take approximately 1 - 2 hours to complete.

Recommended resources

In addition to your Learner Study Pack, use the below references for more information on Leadership:

- APM Body of Knowledge Seventh edition 3.2.4 (Leadership)
- APM (2021) Cultivate different leadership styles to create collaborative teams <https://www.apm.org.uk/blog/cultivate-different-leadership-styles-to-create-collaborative-teams/#:~:text=Two%20years%20later%2C%20the%20APM%20Body%20of%20Knowledge,t o%20empower%20and%20inspire%20people%20to%20achieve%20success%E2%80%9D>
- APM (2018) How leadership style affects team ownership? <https://www.apm.org.uk/blog/how-leadership-style-affects-team-ownership/>
- APM (2023) How does emotional intelligence contribute to project management success? <https://www.apm.org.uk/blog/how-does-emotional-intelligence-contribute-to-project-management-success/>

Overview

To accomplish successful project work, project managers need a combination of technical, business and leadership skills.

Effective leaders keep their teams motivated and enthusiastic, as well as focused on the project.

They both encourage and give space to allow their team members to do their best and accomplish the work with recognition and reward of their contribution.

Leadership Models

There are many leadership models available, and the most useful ones demonstrate the impact of effective leadership on team performance and motivation.

Here are three leadership models that show this correlation between effective leadership and performance:

- Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

Leader can support team performance by identifying which level of need the team member is seeking to address.

Each need must be satisfied in turn and once satisfied then ceases to continue to motivate.

Motivation will derive from individuals looking to move to the level above.

- Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory

Leaders should address "hygiene factors" for individual first to remove potential job dissatisfaction and then focus on "motivators."

Hygiene factors to consider are working conditions such as pay, policies etc.

Motivators should increase job satisfaction by providing opportunities for tangible results and recognising individuals when they achieve their goals.

- McGregor's Theory X & Y

This theory considers that effective leadership comes from adapting the leadership style to the individuals in the team.

The leader determines whether team members are theory X workers - they dislike work and are naturally unmotivated to work, or theory Y workers – they are self-motivated, creative, enjoy work and take pride in what they do.

Different Leadership Styles

Leaders need to adapt their style and approach to the needs of the team and the work that needs to be accomplished. Choices of leadership style include:

Autocratic	• Strong one-dimensional leadership style, where leader has full authority. • Appropriate to address an issue that threatens the achievement of objectives, where issues become critical or where team members are new and lacking motivation.
Participative / Democratic	• Leader involves team members in decision-making process. • Suitable when there is time to focus on development of the team, to build team relationships, collaboration is valued. Some decision-making will be passed on to suitably skilled team members.
Delegative / Laissez-Faire	• Self-rule, where employees are empowered to make decisions • Suitable when the team is established and working well, and has the required knowledge to work independently without direction.

Coaching and Mentoring

Adopting a coaching and/or mentoring style can be a very effective way to support team members, but also ensure that they remain empowered and autonomous in their work.

The key factors in a coaching/mentoring style are:

- **Understanding individual strengths and weaknesses**
 - Adapting leadership style to the individual needs.
 - Providing greater amount of direction for new team members with an appetite for learning and advancing within the project.
 - Coaching when team members become more embedded and experienced.
 - Engaging and delegating responsibilities where skill is fully established, and motivation is high.
- **Understanding the situation**
 - Where there are critical, urgent or changing situations a directive style might be more appropriate.
 - Where change is needed, guidance from the leader might be needed.
 - When the change is embedded, the leader can then move to a supportive, coaching and engaging style.
- **Dealing with uncertainty**
 - The team may need the leader to create a supportive environment through coaching and engaging in order to feel safe when working.

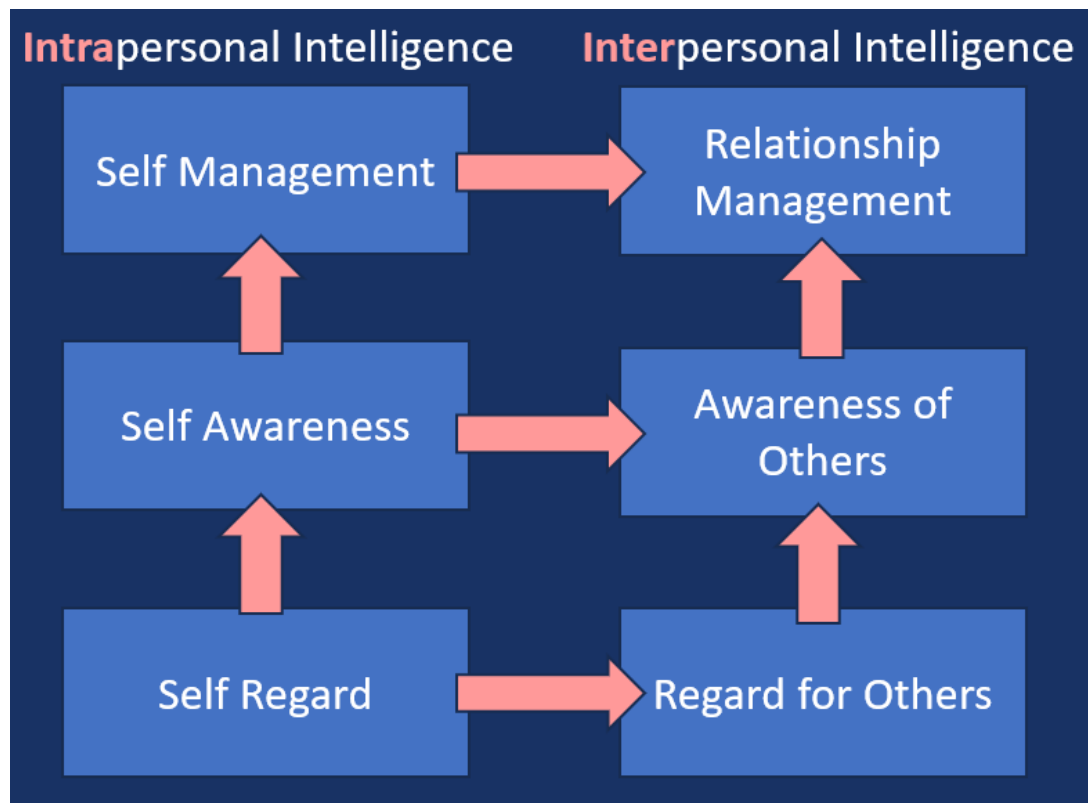
- By being supportive and less directive, the leader is demonstrating that they trust the team to cope with this project circumstance. This will make the team members feel valued and empowered.

Emotional Intelligence (EQ)

An effective project manager must have excellent technical ability and organisational insight, but one skill that is sometimes overlooked is emotional intelligence (EQ).

Being emotionally intelligent is about demonstrating skills in three areas:

- Behavioural – the practice of managing our personality and directing our behaviour to be both personally and interpersonally effective.
- Feelings – the practice of 'thinking about feeling' and 'feeling about thinking' as a guide for our behaviour.
- Attitude – the extent and effectiveness by which we do this is largely determined by our attitude or mindset, both in relation to ourselves and towards others.



Scenario One:

The Snappy Appy renovation project will come with some 'growing pains' as the company gets bigger with the demands of its customers.

Currently the Customer Services Team is a small group of people working from their own homes and responding to queries through the central 'job allocation' software that Sandeep, Head of Development, created.

The renovation will allow for the Customer Services Team to move into an onsite space, as well as continue to allow some of the team to work from their homes.

Lee, the HR Manager, has been asked to recruit a new Customer Services Team Leader to manage the team and guide them through the expansion.

Lee's experience comes mainly from more strategic HR roles, so they've asked if you can help with the desired leadership attributes that should be included in the recruitment advertisement.

List the leadership attributes/behaviours/characteristics that you think should be included in the recruitment advertisement for the new Team Leader position.

Which leadership models that you've explored in this competency do you think would be most appropriate for the Customer Services Team and why?

Scenario Two:

Lee knows that Ayo, the Founder/CEO, struggles with the concept of hybrid working as they believe it doesn't reflect the culture of Snappy Appy – a vibrant, interactive environment where people are constantly bouncing creative and innovative ideas off each other!

The shift to hybrid working will make Lee's recruitment responsibilities easier as it will provide a wider pool of potential recruits and grow the Customer Services Team faster.

Lee has set up a meeting with Ayo to reassure them that the shift to a hybrid team is the right thing to do, especially with the addition of the new Team Leader (once the position is filled).

This is going to be a 'tough sell', so Lee wants to make sure that they have thought of all the possible questions that Ayo could ask. They would particularly like to focus on the unique challenge of leading a hybrid team to ensure that they can answer any concerns that Ayo may have about the new role.

What are the unique challenges that may come about from leading a hybrid team made up of both onsite team members and team members that work from home?

Which of the three leadership styles do you think would be most appropriate in this context?

What situations would require adopting a different leadership style and which one would you use in that context?

You may find the Team Management competency useful in answering these questions.

Scenario Three:

Great news! Lee has started advertising the new Team Leader role and the feedback from the recruitment agencies is that there is a lot of interest from a lot of skilled and experienced individuals.

This means that the recruitment process will take longer than anticipated, especially the shortlisting and interviewing.

Ayo has asked that Lee steps in as the Acting Team Leader until the position is filled and Lee has never led a Customer Service team before, so this is a whole new challenge.

The absence of leadership and the growing demands on the Customer Services Team has led to a drop in performance and customer satisfaction scores. The team seems lethargic and demotivated, and Ayo is becoming concerned.

Lee knows that you have experience in leading a team and so has come to you asking for help to reinvigorate the Customer Services Team.

What could Lee do to engage with the team and motivate them to increase their performance?

Which coaching/mentoring behaviours/techniques could Lee use to help the Customer Services Team?

Learning review questions

Before you attempt the exam practice questions in the next section, we recommend you review your learning to quickly see which aspects you don't understand or can't remember as well.

It will also boost your confidence by confirming what you have learnt and your demonstrated ability to apply that knowledge, so that you are ready to practise for the exam.

Here are some questions you may wish to answer to review your learning from the Leadership section:

- What are the benefits of each of the different leadership styles?
- How can a leader best determine the appropriate leadership style to adopt?
- How can an effective leader motivate their team?
- At what stage/s in a project's implementation could adopting a coaching/mentoring style be most effective?
- What are the benefits of increased emotional intelligence (EQ)?

Exam practice questions

12.1 When considering leadership impact on team performance and motivation, which leadership model emphasises the importance of addressing basic human requirements?
(1 mark)

- a. Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs
- b. Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory
- c. McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y
- d. Vroom's Expectancy Theory

12.2 As a Project Manager, which leadership style would be best when solving a critical issue that threatens your project's success?
(1 mark)

- a. Mentoring
- b. Delegating
- c. Coaching
- d. Directive

12.3 You are managing a project team that includes some team members that are fairly new to project management.

Explain three benefits why a coaching and mentoring style of leadership is essential for leading a team with less experienced members. (3 marks)

Explain two benefits that the role of emotional intelligence in effectively implementing a coaching and mentoring approach within the team. (2 marks)

12.4 As a project manager, you will need to motivate members of your team. Theory X and Theory Y theories proposed by McGregor describe contrasting models of motivation and management.

What is a characteristic of a Theory X worker and what management style would be appropriate for them?
(2 marks)

12.5 You are new to a project and your team consists of various people from across the business.

What are two reasons why a participative leadership style may be appropriate during your initial work with them?
(2 marks)

12.6 You are leading your team through a time of uncertainty in your organisation. The project is in handover and closure phase with most of the team in a quiet phase, working on their own development.

In this situation, it would be most appropriate for you as a leader to provide _____(a)_____.

You decide to take the opportunity to further develop your emotional intelligence as a leader, knowing that as well as being empathetic, it's important to also _____(b)_____.

(2 marks)

(a)

1. Close supervision
2. Training according to project needs
3. Clear goals and objectives
4. Mentoring and support

(b)

1. Trust your emotions
2. Regulate your emotions
3. Share your emotions
4. Hide your emotions

Exam practice answers

Question	Answer / Mark scheme
12.1	A
12.2	D
12.3	Explanation of Coaching and Mentoring Style: - Identifies three benefits of coaching & mentoring along with a clear explanation of why each of the benefits is essential for leading a team with less experienced members, example answer is not exhaustive of the benefits. (1 mark for each benefit and explanation; 3 marks total) For example: Skill Development: A coaching and mentoring style of leadership is essential during Phase 2 to facilitate the growth and development of less experienced team members. Unlike Phase 1, where a directive approach may have been necessary to meet tight deadlines, Phase 2 offers a more conducive environment for skill-building and knowledge transfer. By adopting a coaching and mentoring approach, team members can receive personalised guidance, feedback, and support to enhance their capabilities and confidence. Empowerment and Ownership: Coaching and mentoring empower team members to take ownership of their roles and responsibilities, fostering a sense of autonomy and accountability. Instead of relying solely on directives from the leader, team members are encouraged to proactively seek solutions, collaborate with peers, and make informed decisions. This not only promotes individual growth but also strengthens team cohesion and collective problem-solving abilities. Long-Term Success: Investing in the development of less experienced team members through coaching and mentoring contributes to the long-term success of the project and the organisation as a whole. As team members gain new skills, knowledge, and confidence, they become valuable assets capable of tackling complex challenges and driving innovation. Moreover, a culture of continuous learning and development fosters employee engagement, retention, and loyalty. Explanation of Role of Emotional Intelligence (2 marks): - Explains the role of emotional intelligence in effectively implementing a coaching and mentoring approach within the team. For example: Empathy and Understanding: Emotional intelligence plays a crucial role in effectively implementing a coaching and mentoring approach within the team. Leaders with high emotional intelligence demonstrate empathy and understanding towards the unique needs, strengths, and challenges of each team member. By recognising and validating individual experiences and emotions, leaders can establish trust and rapport, creating a supportive environment conducive to learning and growth. Adaptability and Flexibility: Emotional intelligence enables leaders to adapt their coaching and mentoring style to suit the preferences and learning styles of different team members. By recognising when to provide guidance, when to offer autonomy, and when to adjust their approach based on individual needs, leaders can tailor their interactions to maximise effectiveness and foster positive outcomes.
12.4	1 mark for stating a characteristic of a Theory X workers for example: - Unmotivated. - Dislike of work. - Unambitious.

	• Unwilling to take responsibility. • Motivated by self-interest. 1 mark for stating a management approach which would be most suited to a Theory X worker, for example: • Directive management style. • Close supervision / management / monitoring. • Rewards and punishment / 'carrot and stick' approach / reward good performance and punish poor performance. • Checking each piece of work to ensure it's correct. • Maintain complete control of the work.
12.5	1 mark per reason, 2 marks available in total, for example: • Will support building team relationships. • Will allow you to assess which team members are skilled decision makers / will allow you to understand the team's strengths and weaknesses. • Promotes inclusivity. • Will develop trust within the team. • Will promote collaboration within the team. • Will allow you to learn about/understand the project. • Will ensure better decision-making.
12.6	(a) 4 (b) 2